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THE WALL STREET JOURNAL.

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DJIA 44556.34 ▲ 10.26 0.02% NASDAQ 20041.26 ▲ 0.1% STOXX 600 557.17 ▲ 0.3% 10-YR. TREAS. ▼ 17/32, yield 4.542% OIL $71.85 ▲ $1.11 GOLD $2,931.60 ▲ $48.00 EURO $1.0446 YEN 152.06

What's News

Business & Finance

◆ **Airbus has a new jet**, the A321XLR, that is winning over some of Boeing's best customers and raising the specter of more trouble ahead for the U.S. plane maker. **A1**

◆ **Investors backing plans** for an artificial-intelligence data center in South Korea say the plant could produce up to 3 gigawatts of power at a cost of as much as $35 billion. **B1**

◆ **Bearishness among** individuals reached 47.3%, the highest level since November 2023, a new survey of investor sentiment found. **B1**

◆ **U.S. stocks advanced**, with the S&P rising 0.2% to a record and the Dow industrials and Nasdaq each gaining less that 0.1%. **B12**

◆ **Shift4 Payments struck** a deal for Global Blue Group, a tax-free shopping services provider, in a bid to win over more major retailers as customers. **B3**

◆ **Baidu reported** lower revenue for the third straight quarter but doubled its profit as the search-engine giant's growing AI business partly offset weak ad demand. **B4**

◆ **Truck maker Scania** agreed to buy Northvolt's heavy-industry business as the battery maker continues to work through a restructuring. **B4**

◆ **J&J kicked off its** bankruptcy-plan confirmation in its third attempt to resolve one of the largest mass tort lawsuits through an affiliate it placed into chapter 11. **B5**

◆ **Fidelity Investments** posted record annual operating profit and revenue last year after the stock market rally drew more money into its funds and spurred customers' trading. **B11**

World-Wide

◆ **The U.S. and Russia** agreed to appoint teams to negotiate to settle the war in Ukraine, marking an end to three years of U.S. policy that focused on isolating Moscow and supporting Kyiv for as long as it was willing to keep fighting. **A1, A7**

◆ **Kirill Dmitriev, a** U.S.-educated veteran of Russia's power elite who has close familial and business ties to Putin, has emerged as an intermediary between the Kremlin and the White House. **A6**

◆ **Hamas said it would** release three living hostages ahead of schedule on Saturday as Israel agreed to begin talks to permanently end the war in Gaza and free the remaining hostages. **A16**

◆ **The Senate voted** 51-45 to confirm Howard Lutnick as commerce secretary, putting in place a Wall Street veteran turned avowed protectionist to lead the president's global trade agenda. **A3**

◆ **Trump signed an** executive order that seeks to give his political appointees far-reaching control over federal agencies that for decades operated independently of White House influence. **A4**

◆ **Hundreds of FAA** employees were fired over the weekend, fueling worry among government and industry officials over new risks to air safety. **A5**

◆ **Brazil's former President** Jair Bolsonaro was charged with plotting to overturn his 2022 election loss. **A16**

◆ **Illegal border crossings** plummeted even further in the first weeks of the Trump administration, accelerating a trend that started under former President Biden. **A3**

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Not Invited: Zelensky Sidelined in Negotiations



CAGLA GURDOGAN/REUTERS

TABLE TALK: Ukraine's President Volodymyr Zelensky listens as Turkey's President Recep Tayyip Erdogan speaks during a joint press conference in Ankara, Turkey, on Tuesday, while U.S. and Russian negotiators held discussions without Ukraine. **A7**

Russia And U.S. Seek Out New Path In Ukraine

Trump suggests Ukrainian elections as a condition for Kyiv attending talks

RIYADH, Saudi Arabia—The U.S. and Russia agreed to appoint teams to negotiate to settle the war in Ukraine, marking an end to three years of U.S. policy that focused on

*By **Michael R. Gordon, Brian Schwartz** and **James Marson***

isolating Moscow and supporting Kyiv for as long as it was willing to keep fighting.

Hours after the announcement, President Trump signaled he supports holding elections in Ukraine if it wants to take part in negotiations to end the three-year-old war with Russia, a move that's likely to further isolate Kyiv as Moscow and Wash-

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◆ **Putin's dealmaker takes big role in talks..... A6**

◆ **Europeans bicker as they are left out..... A7**

The Drama Behind Trump's Power Play At Kennedy Center

The opening scene in the story of President Trump's takeover of the John F. Kennedy Center for the Performing Arts is a flashback to August 2017, months into his first term as president.

*By **Erich Schwartzel, Josh Dawsey, Jessica Toonkel** and **John Jurgensen***

Soon after the national cultural center named five luminaries as recipients of its annual Kennedy Center Honors, the new president came under attack over his response to deadly violence at a white-supremacist rally in Charlottesville, Va.

Three of the 2017 honorees—Lionel Richie, TV legend Norman Lear and dancer Carmen de Lavallade—told the center they would refuse to attend the customary White House reception held before a star-studded ceremony of performances and tributes, people involved in that year's program said. The trio indicated they didn't want to meet the president.

Kennedy Center officials and

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◆ **Trump makes broad use of emergency declarations.. A4**

Success of New Airbus Jet Poses Challenge for Boeing

BY BENJAMIN KATZ

Airbus has a new jet that is winning over some of Boeing's best customers. It also raises the specter of more trouble ahead for the U.S. plane maker.

The European company started delivering the new aircraft—the A321XLR—late last year against a backdrop of manufacturing upheaval and financial strain at its U.S. rival. So far the XLR has racked up more than 500 orders, many from airlines looking to replace older Boeing planes.

The jet's success is one of the starkest signs yet of the diverging fortunes of the two companies, with Boeing's troubles leading to gaps in its product lineup that are now being exploited by Airbus. It is also a warning of a bigger threat looming: While Boeing is strapped for cash, Airbus is increasingly investing in an entirely new generation of aircraft that could shape the duopoly for decades to come.

American Airlines and United Airlines have chosen Airbus's XLR to replace their aging Boeing 757 fleets. Other airlines including Australia's Qantas have also purchased the XLR—the first time that carrier has ordered one of Airbus's smaller, narrow-body jets.

Central to the XLR's appeal is a giant fuel tank behind the wings that means the aircraft can carry up to 220 passengers on trips as long as 11 hours. That is far longer than typical narrow-body jets, allowing airlines to open up new direct routes—including across the Atlantic—without needing to sell as many tickets as they would with a bigger, wide-body plane.

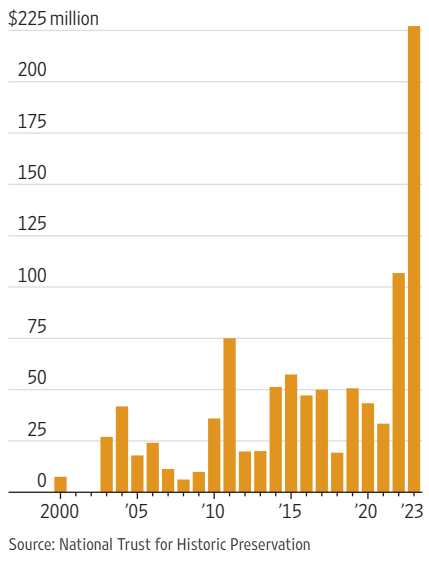
The new model—the latest in its A320 family of aircraft—has another advantage: It doesn't have much competition. Boeing discontinued the 757 in 2004 and shelved plans to build a new aircraft that would have competed directly with the XLR in 2020. The U.S. company's main rival aircraft—the 737 MAX 10—is

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Home Sweet Hospital

Closed hospitals and the land they are built on are becoming a prime target for towns around the country looking to boost limited housing stock. In 2023, spending on these projects eligible for a 20% federal historic tax credit totaled more than $225 million, an analysis of data found. **B1**

Spending on hospital-to-residential conversions approved for 20% tax credit



Source: National Trust for Historic Preservation

How Chinese Brokers Took Over Money Laundering of Fentanyl

On an October morning in 2022, an alleged drug trafficker drove a white pickup truck into the parking lot of a Global Fresh Market in San

*By **Patricia Kowsmann, Dylan Tokar** and **Brian Spegele***

Gabriel, Calif., and stopped alongside a blue Maserati.

After a quick discussion with a woman in the Maserati, the man placed a large black bag in the sports car's back seat. Members of a U.S. government task force, who were watching, said it contained some $300,000 in cash.

The drop was part of what U.S. officials said is a new front in the country's war on drugs: an emerging partnership that has made China a crucial pit stop for dirty money flowing from the U.S.'s fentanyl crisis, according to law-enforcement officials and court documents.

Chinese money brokers, part of an underground banking system that has long served the country's immigrant diaspora, have become go-to partners for fentanyl traffickers and other criminal groups needing to launder illicit drug profits, officials said.

Long operating in the shadows, the Chinese brokers use intermediaries, such as the woman in the Maserati, to collect drug profits from fentanyl dealers. Then, through a series of transactions, they sell those dollars to Chinese customers who want cash in the U.S. for purposes such as buying real estate or other invest-

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He's 42, Works in Finance and Dominates a Sport

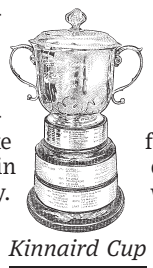
* * *

Tom Dunbar has long ruled Eton Fives, but gravity is catching up

BY MAX COLCHESTER

LONDON — Perhaps the most dominant British athlete in recent history is 42 years old, has a sore knee and spends his days behind a desk in central London helping run a $1.5 billion finance company.

For nearly a quarter of a century, Tom Dunbar has ruled the game of Eton Fives. The sport, a form of handball which is largely the preserve of Britain's top private schools, is played on a court modeled after the medieval chapel wall at Eton College. Think squash but played with your hands and with a gothic buttress jutting into the middle of the court.



Kinnaird Cup

In Britain there are around a hundred people who take this sport, played in pairs, very seriously. Dunbar has spent most of his adult life destroying them. He has won the game's most prestigious tournament, the Kinnaird Cup, 19 times in the past 24 years. He and his playing partner once went 13 years without losing a match.

But the sun may be setting on the Eton GOAT's dynasty. Gravity is catching up with the lanky finance executive. A ligament has detached from the top of his foot. His wife wants him to quit. Dunbar is having to lift weights to keep up with a younger generation of players, and rumors are circulating on the Fives circuit that he hired a personal trainer to stay in shape. (He denies it). And for the

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INSIDE



CIRO DE LUCA/REUTERS

WORLD NEWS
Health concerns grow for Pope Francis, who the Vatican says has pneumonia. **A16**



BUSINESS & FINANCE
Large-volume buyers flock to the 'Wall Street of Eggs' for its online marketplace. **B1**